Institute Collaborator Portal

Final Development Brief

Foundation Release (Version 1.0)

Request for Final Proposal

Chicago, Illinois, USA

August 2026

Confidential

This document is provided exclusively to developers invited to participate in the final stage of the Institute Collaborator Portal evaluation process.

Its purpose is to communicate the Institute's refined vision, governance principles, technical objectives, and implementation expectations so that all finalists prepare their proposals from an identical understanding of the project.

This document supersedes all previous discussions, proposals, and preliminary specifications relating to the Foundation Release.

Foreword

Over the past several weeks, the Active Longevity Institute has undertaken a comprehensive review of multiple independent software development proposals for the Institute Collaborator Portal.

Rather than selecting a developer based solely upon an initial proposal, the Institute chose to engage in a collaborative evaluation process, inviting experienced software architects to review the project's objectives, identify potential challenges, recommend improvements, and suggest appropriate implementation strategies.

This document reflects the outcome of that process.

It represents the Institute's refined understanding of the project's objectives, governance principles, architectural priorities, and implementation strategy.

The purpose of this Final Development Brief is to provide every finalist with an identical foundation from which to prepare a final proposal.

The Institute believes that meaningful comparison is only possible when every developer is responding to the same clearly defined expectations.

This document therefore serves as the common reference for the final stage of the developer selection process.

1. Purpose

The **Institute Collaborator Portal** is a secure, invitation-based professional collaboration platform being developed by the **Active Longevity Institute**.

The Portal is intended to provide a trusted environment where carefully selected professionals from around the world can discover one another, exchange ideas, and develop meaningful interdisciplinary collaborations in areas related to healthy aging and longevity.

Unlike conventional social networking platforms, the Institute Collaborator Portal is not intended to maximize membership or public engagement. Its purpose is to cultivate a carefully curated community of professionals whose expertise, experience, and commitment contribute to advancing the Institute's mission.

The Foundation Release described in this document represents the first step in a long-term development strategy. While future phases will expand the Portal's capabilities, the objective of the Foundation Release is to deliver a secure, production-ready platform that

the Institute can immediately begin using to admit collaborators and foster professional relationships.

2. Project Vision

The Active Longevity Institute was established upon a simple but important conviction:

The questions surrounding healthy aging and longevity are too important and too complex for any one discipline.

Meaningful progress requires researchers, physicians, psychologists, neuroscientists, gerontologists, nutrition scientists, exercise physiologists, public health experts, policy makers, technologists, economists, educators, and many others to learn from one another.

The Institute Collaborator Portal exists to create the conditions where those conversations can occur.

Rather than functioning as another public networking platform, the Portal will serve as a trusted professional environment where carefully selected collaborators can discover complementary expertise, establish meaningful professional relationships, and develop interdisciplinary collaborations that advance knowledge related to healthy aging and longevity.

Every design decision should support that purpose.

3. Guiding Principles

The Institute requests that every design and development decision be guided by the following principles.

Quality over Quantity

The objective is not to build the largest professional network.

The objective is to build the most trusted professional community possible.

Invitation-Based Community

Admission to the Portal is governed by the Institute.

Membership is earned through a thoughtful admission process rather than open registration.

Simplicity

The Foundation Release should emphasize clarity, reliability, and ease of use.

Every feature should have a clear purpose.

Complexity should never be introduced merely because it is technically possible.

Long-Term Thinking

Every architectural decision should support the Institute's long-term roadmap.

Future capabilities should extend the existing foundation rather than require significant redevelopment.

As one reviewer observed during the evaluation process:

The project should phase the surface area, not the foundation.

That philosophy captures the Institute's approach to development.

Institutional Thinking

The Collaborator Portal is not a stand-alone software application.

It is a long-term institutional asset of the Active Longevity Institute.

All design, architecture, documentation, and implementation decisions should reflect that responsibility.

Partnership

The Institute seeks a long-term technology partner rather than simply a software contractor.

At the same time, the Portal must remain fully portable so that its continued development is never dependent upon any individual developer or development company.

4. Definition of the Foundation Release

Throughout this document, the term **Foundation Release** is used intentionally.

The Institute is **not** seeking a prototype, demonstration system, proof of concept, or minimum viable product.

Instead, the Foundation Release shall be a secure, production-ready implementation of the Portal that the Institute can immediately begin using as part of its day-to-day operations.

While future milestones will expand the Portal's capabilities, the Foundation Release must already provide meaningful operational value.

Upon deployment, the Institute should be able to:

- Invite collaborators.
- Review collaborator applications and referrals.
- Admit approved collaborators.
- Maintain professional collaborator profiles.
- Provide a searchable collaborator directory.
- Administer the platform securely.
- Begin building the Institute's international collaborator community immediately.

The Foundation Release should therefore represent a complete and usable operational platform rather than an incomplete first step.

5. Collaborator Admission

The Active Longevity Institute is a carefully curated professional community.

Admission to the Institute Collaborator Portal is governed by the Institute and is intended to preserve the quality, integrity, professionalism, and interdisciplinary character of the collaborator community.

The Foundation Release shall support **three admission pathways**, each culminating in review and approval by the Institute.

5.1 Direct Invitation

The primary method of admission shall be direct invitation by the Institute.

Initially, invitations will be issued by the Founder.

The architecture shall support additional authorized Institute officers in future phases.

The system shall provide:

- Creation of invitations
- Secure single-use invitation links
- Invitation expiration
- Invitation tracking
- Invitation acceptance

- Registration following acceptance

5.2 Referral by an Approved Collaborator

Approved collaborators may recommend another professional for consideration.

The Portal shall provide a structured online referral form.

The referral should include information such as:

- Name
- Organization
- Professional title
- Area(s) of expertise
- Country
- Email address
- Reason for recommendation
- Relationship to the referring collaborator
- Additional comments

A referral **does not constitute admission**.

Each referral shall be reviewed individually by the Institute before an invitation is issued.

5.3 Application through the Institute Website

Visitors to **activelongevityinstitute.org** may express interest in becoming collaborators.

The Institute website shall provide a **Become a Collaborator** page containing an online application form.

The application shall request professional information sufficient for the Institute to evaluate the applicant's suitability.

Submission of an application **does not constitute admission**.

Each application shall be reviewed individually by the Institute before any invitation is issued.

Administrative Review

Both referrals and website applications shall appear within a central administrative review area inside the Portal.

The reviewing administrator shall be able to:

- Review each submission
- Approve or decline applicants
- Issue invitations
- Maintain a history of admission decisions

Initially, the Founder will serve as the primary reviewing administrator.

The architecture shall support multiple administrators in future phases.

Admission decisions remain solely at the discretion of the Active Longevity Institute.

6. Phase 1 Functional Scope

The Foundation Release should provide a complete, secure, and production-ready operational platform.

The following functionality is expected to be included.

Authentication

- Secure authentication
- Password management
- Password reset
- Secure session management
- Multi-factor authentication for administrator accounts

Collaborator Profiles

Approved collaborators shall maintain professional profiles including, where appropriate:

- Name
- Photograph
- Organization

- Position
- Biography
- Areas of expertise
- Research interests
- Collaboration interests
- Country
- Languages
- Website
- LinkedIn profile
- Publications (links only)
- Collaboration availability

Profiles should be easy to update and designed to accommodate future expansion.

Collaborator Directory

Approved collaborators shall be able to browse the professional community through a searchable directory.

The initial directory should emphasize simplicity and ease of use.

Basic Search

The Foundation Release should include basic search functionality.

Initially, searching by the following fields is sufficient:

- Name
- Area of expertise

Additional search capabilities and advanced filtering may be introduced in later milestones.

Administration

The administrative dashboard shall enable the Institute to:

- Manage invitations
- Review applications

- Review referrals
- Admit collaborators
- Manage collaborator profiles
- Monitor platform activity
- Manage notifications

The objective is to provide the Institute with the tools necessary to operate the Portal effectively from the first day of deployment.

Notifications

The system shall generate email notifications for significant events, including:

- Invitations
- Registration
- Admission decisions
- Referral submissions
- Website applications
- Password resets

Future milestones may expand notification capabilities.

7. Success Criteria

The Foundation Release shall be considered successful when the Active Longevity Institute can confidently begin operating the Portal as part of its normal activities.

Specifically, the Institute should be able to:

- Invite collaborators.
- Receive collaborator referrals.
- Receive collaborator applications through the Institute website.
- Review and admit collaborators.
- Maintain professional collaborator profiles.
- Search the collaborator directory.

- Securely administer the platform.
- Begin building an international collaborator community.

Most importantly:

The Institute should feel confident inviting its first one hundred collaborators to use the Portal.

If the Institute is comfortable introducing the Portal to respected professionals around the world, then the Foundation Release will have achieved its primary objective.

8. Development Strategy

The Active Longevity Institute views the Collaborator Portal as a long-term institutional asset rather than a short-term software project.

Accordingly, the Institute intends to develop the Portal through a series of carefully planned contractual milestones, while maintaining a single, unified architectural vision.

The Institute strongly supports the following principle:

The architecture should be designed once, while functionality is introduced progressively through successive milestones.

In practical terms, this means that future milestones should extend the Portal rather than require redesign or redevelopment of its underlying architecture.

The Foundation Release should therefore establish:

- The core data model
- Authentication framework
- Permissions structure
- Database architecture
- API structure
- Security model

Future milestones should primarily extend the Portal's capabilities while preserving these foundations.

9. Funding and Milestone Structure

The Institute anticipates a total development investment of approximately **USD $6,000**, distributed across **three or four contractual milestones** over approximately three to four months.

Each milestone shall conclude with:

- Demonstration of completed functionality
- Review by the Institute
- Acceptance or requested revisions
- Formal GO / NO GO decision before authorization of the next milestone

This approach allows the Institute to:

- Manage cash flow responsibly.
- Evaluate progress objectively.
- Maintain flexibility throughout development.
- Ensure every milestone delivers meaningful operational value.

The Institute does **not** view each milestone as a separate project.

Rather, each milestone represents another stage in the construction of a single long-term platform.

10. Ownership

The Institute Collaborator Portal is a long-term institutional asset of the Active Longevity Institute.

Accordingly, the Institute shall retain exclusive ownership of all project assets created during development.

These include, but are not limited to:

- Domain configuration
- Hosting accounts
- Cloud infrastructure
- Database

- Source code
- Git repository
- Administrator accounts
- API keys
- SSL certificates
- Documentation
- Deployment scripts
- Intellectual property created specifically for this project

The selected developer shall receive appropriate administrative access necessary to perform development work.

Ownership of all assets shall remain exclusively with the Active Longevity Institute.

11. Portability

The Institute seeks a long-term technology partner.

At the same time, the Portal must remain fully portable.

If, at any point in the future, another qualified developer assumes responsibility for continued development, the transition should occur without requiring redevelopment of the platform.

Upon completion of each contractual milestone, the developer shall provide:

- Updated source code
- Database schema
- Deployment documentation
- Configuration documentation
- Technical documentation
- README documentation
- Change log summarizing milestone work

The objective is to ensure that another competent developer could continue development efficiently using the documentation provided.

12. Website Integration

The Collaborator Portal shall function as an integrated component of:

activelongevityinstitute.org

Visitors will interact with the Institute through the public website.

Authorized collaborators will access the Portal through a secure **Collaborator Login** button located on the Institute website.

The Portal should not appear to be a separate website.

Rather, it should present a seamless continuation of the Institute's identity and user experience.

Visual Identity

The Institute's website designer will provide:

- Logo
- Typography
- Color palette
- Buttons
- Icons
- General visual language
- Page design guidance

The selected developer is responsible for implementing these design elements consistently throughout the Portal.

The developer is **not** expected to create a separate visual identity for the Portal.

The Collaborator Portal should appear as a natural extension of the Institute website.

13. Definition of "Production Ready"

Throughout this document, the phrase **production-ready** refers to an operational platform that the Institute can confidently place into active day-to-day use.

For purposes of this project, a production-ready Foundation Release means:

- Secure deployment
- Stable operation
- Appropriate backup strategy
- Secure authentication
- Invitation-based admission
- Collaborator profiles
- Collaborator directory
- Basic collaborator search
- Administrative management
- Email notifications
- Appropriate documentation

The Foundation Release should allow the Institute to begin inviting collaborators immediately upon deployment.

The Institute is **not** seeking a demonstration prototype or proof of concept.

The Foundation Release should represent a complete operational platform suitable for immediate institutional use.

14. Deliverables

At the completion of the Foundation Release, the Institute expects delivery of:

- Fully operational Collaborator Portal
- Production deployment
- Source code
- Database
- Documentation
- Deployment documentation
- Administrator documentation
- README documentation

- Configuration documentation
- Initial administrator training (if required)
- Assistance with deployment and transition into production

15. Response Requested from Finalists

The purpose of these questions is not simply to compare technical approaches, but to better understand how each developer thinks about long-term software architecture, institutional development, project governance, and partnership.

Final proposals should address the following questions.

1. Foundation Release

Do you agree that the functionality described in this document represents an appropriate Foundation Release?

If not, what would you recommend changing, and why?

2. Scope Management

Which requested feature(s), if any, would you recommend postponing to a later milestone?

Please explain your reasoning.

3. Long-Term Architecture

How will you ensure that future milestones can be added without requiring redesign or redevelopment of the Portal's underlying architecture?

4. Risk Assessment

What aspects of the project do you believe represent the greatest technical or operational risks?

How would you recommend managing those risks?

5. Documentation

How will you document the system to ensure another qualified developer could continue development in the future if necessary?

6. Milestone Recommendations

If you were organizing development yourself, how would you structure the contractual milestones?

Please describe:

- milestone objectives
- expected deliverables
- estimated duration
- estimated budget allocation

7. Recommendations

Based upon your experience, what one recommendation would you make that you believe would most improve the long-term success of this project?

16. Developer Selection Criteria

The Active Longevity Institute appreciates the considerable thought and professionalism demonstrated by every developer participating in this evaluation process.

The Institute recognizes that there are often multiple technically correct approaches to software development.

Accordingly, the final selection will not be based solely upon price or technical capability.

Instead, the Institute intends to evaluate proposals using the following considerations.

Understanding of the Institute's Vision

The selected developer should demonstrate a clear understanding of the Institute's long-term objectives and the purpose of the Collaborator Portal.

Architectural Thinking

Preference will be given to proposals that establish a strong long-term architectural foundation capable of supporting future expansion without unnecessary redevelopment.

Simplicity

The Institute values thoughtful simplicity over unnecessary complexity.

Solutions should be elegant, maintainable, and appropriate for the Foundation Release.

Communication

The Institute values clear, timely, professional communication throughout the project.

Questions, recommendations, and potential concerns should be communicated openly.

Documentation

Comprehensive technical documentation is considered an essential project deliverable rather than an optional addition.

Long-Term Partnership

The Institute seeks a technology partner capable of supporting the Portal as it evolves over many years.

Equally important, the Portal must remain fully portable and never become dependent upon a single developer or organization.

Professional Judgment

The Institute values thoughtful recommendations.

Developers are encouraged to identify opportunities for improvement and to raise concerns whenever they believe a proposed approach may introduce unnecessary technical complexity or long-term risk.

Closing Statement

The Active Longevity Institute extends its sincere appreciation to every developer who has participated in this evaluation process.

The time, expertise, thoughtful recommendations, and professional dialogue shared throughout this process have materially improved the Institute's understanding of the project and have helped shape this Final Development Brief.

Regardless of the final selection, the Institute is grateful for the professionalism demonstrated by all participants.

The Collaborator Portal represents more than a software project.

It is intended to become a long-term institutional resource that brings together professionals from many disciplines who share a common commitment to advancing healthy aging and longevity.

The Institute looks forward to selecting a technology partner who shares that vision and is excited to help build it.

Prepared by
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